

Project Report:

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INTRODUCTION

This report outlines my work in completing the CSE0001 Digital Literacy project assignment for the Digital Literacy course in VIT Bhopal University. The assignment is structured in the following scenario: I have been selected for the role of a Student Digital Ambassador.

The role of a Digital Ambassador is to assist other students in becoming digital literates in a professional manner. Over the course of five different tasks, I have attempted to cover some of the most significant aspects of digital literacy: visual awareness content creation, professional digital presence, use of coding and collaboration tools, professional email creation, and understanding cybercrime.

All of these have been included in a single GitHub repository, which is also part of the assignment. Through this assignment, I have come to understand that digital literacy is not merely about technology; it is about technology in a safe, professional, and productive manner.

The skills learned through this assignment are skills that I will use throughout my academic and professional life.

TASK 1 — Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

For this task, I decided to use Canva to create a one-page infographic that can help other first-year students learn the basics of digital literacy.

I found Canva to be the most suitable option for this task because it is a browser-based application that does not require any downloads, is free to use, and has a wide variety of templates that can be customized easily without any prior knowledge of graphic design.

The infographic has information on three different topics: the meaning of digital literacy, why it is essential for students in today's digital world, internet safety, the need for a professional online presence on platforms such as LinkedIn and GitHub, and so on.

I found it a bit challenging to decide on the content that I should add to the infographic. Digital literacy has a very wide range of topics, and it was not easy to add enough information on a single page without cluttering it.

However, I found that using icons instead of sentences helped communicate information more efficiently. I found this task to be very useful because it helped me understand the importance of visual communication.

TASK 2 — Student Digital Portfolio

To complete this task, I have set up accounts on three different platforms: GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. All three of these sites play a significant role in a student's future career as well as in their academic path.

GitHub is a platform used for hosting code and projects using a system called version control. It is a popular tool among developers and is becoming more and more popular among recruiters and internship programs as a way of screening potential candidates. For my GitHub profile, I created a README file—a special file in GitHub repositories used by users to introduce themselves and state their branch, year, and what they hope to learn during their engineering program.

LinkedIn is a popular social networking site used by professionals around the world. It is used by students as a way of connecting with people in their respective fields and exploring possible internships and job opportunities in these fields.

Under my Education tab on LinkedIn, I have filled in my current level of study, name of my institution, and expected graduation year.

Kaggle is a popular data science and machine learning platform used by data scientists and machine learning practitioners around the world. Even as a freshman, having a Kaggle profile is a great way of expressing one's interests in data science and related fields.

As a student in the next four years, I hope to enhance my profiles on these three sites accordingly.

TASK 3 — Coding and Collaboration Platforms

Part A – Coding Practice:

I registered on the HackerRank platform and completed the basic-level challenge "Solve Me First," where I had to develop a basic function to add two integers. The challenge is basic, but the experience of navigating the platform, reading the challenge description, and submitting the answer is what the experience of competitive programming is all about.

HackerRank also offers skill tracks in Python, SQL, etc., which I intend to utilize as the semester progresses.

Part B – Google Forms Collaboration:

I designed a Google Form with the title "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz" with five questions that test basic knowledge among my batchmates.

The questions are multiple-choice questions on basic knowledge about phishing emails, password best practices, etc., and also include an open-ended question on what is the best digital practice the student follows.

Both the tools, HackerRank and Google Forms, are useful tools for academic purposes. HackerRank is useful for developing programming habits, while Google Forms and Google Sheets are useful tools for data collection, peer assessment, and collaborative work with no additional software required.

TASK 4 — Professional Email and Etiquette

Communication Scenario:

The most documented example of bad digital communication is when people are terminated from their jobs for ranting on social media about their workplaces, unaware that their posts are public and can be viewed by their employer. In one instance, a new employee was terminated before they even started their job, simply because their employer found a series of unprofessional posts on their social media accounts, which were made just days after they were offered a job.

What they should have done differently is obvious: they simply needed to look at their social media privacy settings, avoid posting anything unprofessional, and remember that their personal and professional identity are not far apart on social media. This is a lesson in how digital communication, no matter how casual, has serious implications in real life.

Key Learnings:

This task has taught me a lot, especially in terms of realizing that professional communication is not necessarily common sense, although this may sound silly. What this task has taught me is that a professional email has a number of parts: a subject heading, a greeting, a body, and a closing, and each of these parts has a purpose in professional communication.

Writing two professional emails, one to a professor and another to an internship coordinator, has made me more aware of professional communication, its importance, and its implications on how a message is received by another party.

Task 5. Cybercrime Awareness Case Study

Case Study: UPI / Online Payment Fraud

Online payment fraud using UPI is a problem for college students and young people in India. This is what usually happens: someone. Sends a message to the victim saying they are from the bank or customer care. They tell the victim that there is a problem with their account and they need to fix it away or they will not be able to use it.

The person who is trying to cheat them tells the victim to give them their UPI PIN, OTP or to scan a code they sent. A lot of people do not know that if they scan a code or enter their PIN it will take money out of their account not put money in. This happens fast and the victim loses all their money.

Students are often targeted because they are not used to taking care of their money and they may not know how UPI works.

The results can be very bad: the victim loses their savings it is hard to get the money and they feel very upset. Sometimes the money that was taken is used for illegal things. If someone is a victim they can report it at cybercrime.gov.in or by calling 1930.

Reflection:

What really surprised me when I was looking into this was how easy it is for people to cheat others using UPI. They do not need to be good at computers or know a lot, about technology. They just need to make the victim scared or worried so they do what they say without thinking.

Because of this I am going to change some of my habits. I will never give out my OTP, PIN or UPI information when someone calls or sends me a message no matter how official they sound. I will also check with my bank directly if someone asks me for money using the banks app or phone number.

(Case study saved as casestudy.md and prevention checklist saved as prevention-checklist.md inside task-5-cybercrime/ folder.)

CONCLUSION

This project was really useful for me because it taught me about the parts of digital literacy that affect my life as a student. I got to learn how to use tools to make things look good set up profiles that look professional try out coding on websites send emails in a professional way and think carefully about the bad things that can happen with cybersecurity. What I think is really important is that I started to see how all these things are linked together. Having an online presence is only good if I take care of it and keep it safe from people who might try to trick me or use it wrongly.

The GitHub repository I made for this project is not something I had to turn in. It is the start of my own digital portfolio and I plan to keep adding to it as I go through my degree. I will keep working on my portfolio and I will add more things to it throughout my time, at university and I am excited to see how my digital literacy skills will help me with this project, my digital literacy skills and my digital literacy.

REFERENCES

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GitHub – github.com

LinkedIn – linkedin.com

Kaggle – kaggle.com

HackerRank – hackerrank.com

Google Forms – forms.google.com

National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal – cybercrime.gov.in

Cyber Crime Helpline – 1930